

can be tricked into believing an executable file is a benign bitmap, or graphic, file. To prevent this, ensure file extension viewing is enabled on the system.

Antivirus

Antivirus refers to the products and technology used to detect malicious code, prevent it from infecting your system, and remove malicious code that has infected the system. Typically, antivirus vendors share information and resources to ensure rapid response to malicious code outbreaks. Most antivirus vendors participate in independent testing which certifies their products to detect or disinfect viruses.

Applet

Any miniature application transported over the Internet, especially as an enhancement to a Web page. Authors often embed applets within the HTML page as a foreign program type.

Attack

An attempt to subvert or bypass a system's security. Attacks may be passive or active. Active attacks attempt to alter or destroy data. Passive attacks try to intercept or read data without changing it. See Also: Brute Force Attack, Denial of Service, Hijacking, Password Attacks, Password Sniffing

Attributes

Characteristics assigned to all files and directories. Attributes include: Read Only, Archive, Hidden or System.

Background Scanning

A feature in some antivirus software to automatically scan files and documents as they are created, opened, closed or executed.

Backup

The process of creating duplicate data. Some programs backup data files while maintaining both the current version and the preceding version on disk. However, a backup is not considered secure unless it is stored away from the original.